

Themes

The theme of the sacred realm, beginning with a mosque in Spain

The Great Mosque Cordoba Spain 786 CE

The purpose of these religious buildings is entering a new inner world inside of the building and the normal world, where we can practice ritual and be more introspective. There are elements of purifying yourself with water before entry like wudu in Islam. The dome is very crucial to this work, which is equivalent to heaven, and at the base of the dome we can see a lot of light, it is both functional but it also serves a spiritual function. There are not focal points in the work, you put your prayer mat down and pray. The work makes use of Islamic arches, which are striped with different colors, and also are horseshoe shaped. The courtyard embodies sort of a transition before going into the inner spiritual realm of the church.

Rathnasambhava the Transcendent Buddha 13th Century Ciabue Madonna Enthroned 1280-90
Both works have two central figures, and to convey importance to illiterate populations is the use of a central figure in both work. The central figure is far more active and moving compared to the other surrounding figures. The works are from the same century but had no contact and use similar strategies despite being separate. The choice of colors is the same, but the Indian work uses water color, and the Catholic work uses potentially gold, lapis lazuli, and tempora. Both works use halos.

The indian work shows other bodhisattvas surrounding the buddha that did not undergo nirvana to stay on earth and help people achieve nirvana themselves. Baby jesus looks like a shrunken man in the work also. Jesus is depicted a such because people believed he was born perfect, meaning to many that he was born as a perfect man, or homunculi.

Image Breaking/Iconoclasm, Politics and the social Order

The word began with icons, mary, jesus, and angels, depicted in very typical manners in icon paintings, breaking images typically religious ones, is known as iconoclasm. The result of Christianity splitting between the Orthodox and Catholic world, for awhile the Orthodox world took to destroy all of their religious images, and all images, except for themselves. All religious images were outlawed during this era. After 150 years, Orthodox artists resumed to make art in the same way as if nothing happened.

Protestant Reformation iconoclasim

Protestants looked at the idolatry commandment and they began to whitewash their churches, mostly calvinists and some lutherans.

Islam generally doesn't allow icons as well there are some early works of Muhammed at Yale.

Images can be very threatening and are thus destroyed

Large Buddha Bamiyan Afghanistan 3rd Century 7th Century CE

The Taliban blew up a gigantic Buddha statue in the early 21st century. The Taliban has two problems with representational images, that the act of creation is relegated only to god, and the second is, and fear of idolatry that we may start worshipping the work of art rather than the deity.

Iconoclasm still happens quite often in the modern world, with the destruction of confederate statues

The Great Pyramids of Giza 2500 BCE

The pyramids were constructed over a period of 100 years, each taking roughly 30 years, and each pyramid being the resting place of a pharaoh. We believed many of the workers on the pyramid were enslaved but we do not know for sure. Pharaohs, upon their death, would become gods. The ka is viewed as the other self, and people wanted to preserve their soul or their spirit, by the mummification process people would preserve their ka by preserving their body. If the embalming process fails, then the ka of the failure of the pharaoh can live on in the art, like sculptures. The pyramids are gigantic symbols of power, we don't have to know how to read or to be educated, we can merely glean their power by viewing the sheer size of the pyramids. With the idea of ka's immortality, people would be buried with their possessions, like their gold, their jewels, etc. All of the pyramids were robbed. People started to make smaller pyramids and bury their belongings elsewhere. The only burial found intact with Tutankamen, Carter found king Tut's tomb in the 20s. The pyramids are aligned with the cardinal directions in some manner of north south east west etc. The pyramids inside have a network of tunnels.

The pharaoh would have had their own temple to commune with the gods on their own. Pharaohs ruled very much by divine right.

Menkaure and His Queen 2500 BCE

In case the embalming process failed, the myriad of art works of the Egyptians would allow them to live on forever. The work was made to be buried, it was to preserve a person's ka, since the statue preserves the likeness of these figures. This is an example of artwork for no one to see.

The work is very stiff and has little motion. Egyptian art is very conservative and doesn't change, this is their style. Egyptian art basically did not change for three thousand years. The pharaohs want their works to last forever, they don't want their work to break, they need it in tact for their ka to live on. The work makes use of diorite to incur less chips, in terms of lasting the work is meant to be perfect. There are two poses, standing and seating. One for the scribe too cross legged but that's only for scribes.

Eugene Delacroix Liberty Leading the People 1830

This work comes off of the school of Romanticism. The visual artists join a little later, and the priorities of this school are to evoke emotion. In 1830 there was another uprising against Charles X. Lady liberty a barebreasted female figure is shown with many realistic figures, people are shown with arms taking over. Nationalism is personified with the flag. In the top right is the Notre Dame, a symbol of France. Louis Felipe came into power after 1830, and bought this work, and he returned the work to the artist months later. The work didn't go into public display until 1863. The work was extremely political and only became displayed when there were more political uprisings in the 1860s.

Pablo Picasso Guernica 1937

The work is a mural, very large. The work uses a lot of slicing and dicing fragmentation, and lots of surrealism common to cubist artists. Picasso was an extremely political artist, and this work was his most vocal anti-war work. Picasso was living in France when this work was made. Franco worried there would be an uprising in a small village of Guernica, and he wanted to quell the potential uprising. Franco asked for Guernica to be bombed, massacring it. Picasso captures the shrapnel and destruction of the bombing. The work shows bodies broken apart, on the far right someone running from a broken building. A light bulb in the center speaks to modernity maybe to god. The work uses a minotaur, a half man half human to signify a superhuman god or force. Up close on the work it has little dashes and dots that look like newspaper, since Picasso did not see it. In 1937, Picasso exhibited his work in France for many people to see it at the Spanish pavilion, so that his work would cause a stir. Picasso's work was displayed in the modern metropolitan museum of new york. Picasso died in 1973, but 8 years after his death in 1981 becomes a democracy, and the work is returned to Picasso. Picasso ultimately wanted his work to get to Spain, and this is a major work. Picasso and his gf cover the horse with tiny little strokes, trying to symbolize art breaking through the force of news.

Betye Saar The Liberation of Aunt Jemima 1972

The work includes a racist depiction of a black woman as black people have been historically stereotyped in the US. The racist figure in the center shows a painting being held up of what is likely a more realistic version of the same woman holding a baby, depicted in a realistic manner

without unfair characterization. The title of the work references the fact that african americans were trying to unshackle themselves from unfair stereotypes. The work concerns itself with women, the stereotype of a mammy an african woman taking care of white children. Mammys are shown as jovial figures. The central figure is a racist caricature, and pushes against the racist stereotypes, the work has a sinister undertone. Aunt Jemima was changed to the milling company

Emanuel Lutze Washington crossing the Delaware 1851 Robert Colescott George Washington Carver Crossing the Delaware 1975

On Christmas Eve 1776, Hessian mercenaries held fort in new jersey. Washington knew that the Hessians would drink and celebrate on Christmas eve, and this was a major victory for washington.

Lutze

A very bright work very naturalistic work. The work is mural sized. Washington has a light around him with a divine presence sort of. Much of the work is fictitious. The work is a history painting, and the largest canvases are reserved for history paintings. The work is meant to educate and educate for all time.

Colescott

A cartoonish work intentionally, and appropriation is certainly used. Colescott tries to critique history and art history itself which give a very ideal version of history. History which has been written for centuries which has ignored African American participation in history, which cuts to the heart of American history which has been centric around wasps basically. The work comes from the civil rights era, the work was also made in reference to the 200 year anniversary of the united states.

Roger Shimoomura Shimomura Crossing the delaware

Another work critiquing the treatment of Japanese Americans crossing the delaware and our lack of attention to racial issues.

Stories and Histories

Andrea del Castagno the Youthful David 1448

A 15th century Renaissance work painted onto leather. For a story we need a beginning middle and end, and we need to depict time throughout a story. This isn't a simple task, so people show before and afters. We assume that the audience has some level of foreknowledge. Even if we have an illiterate audience, these people know the stories of David and Goliath. The work shows a beheaded David, showing a slingshot and a decapitated head. The audience would understand this work as "compressed time" Another technique is continuous narration, where we have a beginning middle and end to express time through a story.

William Hogarth A Harlot's Progress 1732

Hogarth made many paintings that would be turned into engravings. These would be turned into almost comic strips weekly. Hogarth was very well known and made a good living with these visual stories. 18th century stories were moralizing, and this work tried to be. Some tried to be funny, this one didn't. The girl's name is Mary Hackabout. There's a lot of danger in the cities, which pointed to wild dumb women who would live in cities alone. Mary is pretended to help by a woman. In the bottom right a goose is cooked, and know the work would end tragically.

For awhile she is a wealthy woman she has to go into prostitution, she makes hemp in prison, and dies of syphilis. We either use 1 image or multiple.

Judith Baca Great Wall of Los Angeles

Frontier California 1880 and treaty of Guadalupe Hidalgo 1848 begun 1974. The work talks about under representation and oppression of Hispanic communities. Baca is given credit but numerous artists were involved.

Christian Boltanski Altar to the Chances High school 1987

The subject matter of the work is the Holocaust. The photographs of students are from 1931 photographs from a graduating class. The pictures have been enlarged, and it is a safe guess that all of the students here died in a concentration camp. The photographs are enlarged and blurred. Boltanski makes us associate high school graduation optimism with the tragedy of their eventual deaths.

Court Ladies and Preparing Newly Woven Silk

The court ladies are essentially doing some kind of ironing, taking silk and heating up a metal rod and then using it to flatten silk. This really is nothing more than people trying to iron out the

wrinkles on a cloth. This work is a 11th century copy, and comes from the 8th century In Asia specifically in Japan and China people mastered copying the same existing works. This work comes from another work, but the original has been lost.

Edward Hopper Gas 1940

A realist work by Hopper a famous American realist. A common quality in Hopper's work is there are usually one or two figures, the works are quiet and lonely typically. The work has a quiet contemplative quality. Like a gas station, street sign, diner, taken all the way to fine art. Modern painting says this is allowed but previous traditions wouldn't allow this to be covered or to happen.

Robert Rauschenberg Windward 1963

The work contains the Sistine Chapel, there's a parrot, there's a statue of liberty in the top right and the bottom left. The work is a commentary of the glut of images coming at people during the 60s with the television and advertisements, we shift from the radio to the TV listening to stories and the news. We can argue that the every day has been rendered here by having our daily experience given back to us. This work reflects a new generation of artists, the origin of media culture. The work is done in silkscreen a photomechanical process. The work is largely a free association. The Sistine Chapel is in the top left with a reference to high art. The oranges we don't really know what they mean, oranges touched by the sun sun kissed.

Robert Rauschenberg Bed 1955 Combine Painting

This is a combine painting, his terminology, and we would call this an assemblage. Rauschenberg takes multiple things from everyday life and then paints on them, he mixes ordinary stuff with new art elements. This work constitutes a work which challenges what art is, Rauschenberg says that there is art and there is life, and I work in the gap between the two, which means that there are 2 domains of art, one of our everyday life of non-art things, and then a fine cordoned off area of art. Rauschenberg takes and rotates the bed sheet upward, it looks very uninviting, it also uses toothbrushes for this work. Rauschenberg is commenting on Pollock's work, bringing down Pollock's sophisticated abstractionism back down to earth.

Robert Rauschenberg Monogram 1959 Combine Painting

The work is a stuffed goat with a tire and many industrial pieces underneath. Rauschenberg says the strongest thing is that he chose to ennoble the ordinary in his art. The Simpsons did various episodes with Rauschenberg, Homer wanted to become an artist, and the whole rift was on Rauschenberg.

Reflecting on the Self

Frida Kahlo Self Portrait with Monkeys 1943

Kahlo's life was very traumatic. She was a Mexican artist who did many self portraits. Kahlo said her art is not surreal, she is not a surrealist but she was a surrealist by school, she said she painted her reality. She is shown in traditional MEXican dress with many monkeys surrounding her. This is one of several self portraits she made. In 1925 Kahlo was hit by a trolley car and a pipe went through her nearly killing her. She went through a lot of physical and psychological trauma, and she was given paint to being to explore painting while bed ridden. Kahlo dealt with abusive husbands too.

The Two Fridas Frida Kahlo

Her father was german and her mom was mexican. On the left an austrian dress, and on the right a Mexican dress. When she came to Ny she popularized the dress. The heart is physically connected between the two. 55 of her works were self portraits.

Frida Kahlo the Broken column 1944

The work shows a woman put together with rods pins and other surgery, depicting her reality as someone who suffered from surgery all her life. Kahlo died quite young. Kahlo went through many miscarriages and operations.

Robert Mapplethorpe Self Portrait 1980

The photographer died of aids. Mapplethorpe did a lot of controversial stuff and was very graphic about the gay lifesyle in new york , he got government funding before and many people why tax paye money was going towards that. He dealt with himself and his life and his homosexuality as the subject of his art. This work shows the use of gendering, where he is shown as feminine on the right.

Hiernymus Bosch the Garden of Earthly Delights

Bosch was a Renaissance artist, and did not fit into the period with other artists despite being a contemporary of famous Renaissance artists. Bosch is Dutch. The work is part of a triptych. Which has closed and open views, which might open during a sunday or holy days, but is kept closed otherwise. The work was commissioned by Henry Nasseu the third, a ruler or aristocrat, it was for a private home not a holy space. There's a lot of strangeness in the work. One of the moe common interpretations is that Bosch was part of an alchemical sect of artists, The work makes use of a lot of tools of alchemists the q6th century equivalent of bunsen burners. The christian inteprrtation shows christ with adam and eve on the left. In the center, we get original sin, which is the delights of garden of even, the garden of earl delights, many strange things or perversions. All of the animals have symbolism. On the right is hell.

There are four steps to alchemy, conjoining or mixing, who brings both adam and eve together. Step 1 is fermentation fornication and perversion, Step 2 is putrefication, burning or hell, and the fourth is cleansing or purificatio which is the flood on the outside. In the cener of Hell, we get a

self portrait of Hieronymous Bosch, Bosch's version of hell is musical instruments, people are being tortured by musical instruments.

Henri Rousseau the Dream 1910

The work is not surrealism, but surrealists discover him. Rousseau is self taught. Rousseau liked to go through the botanical sections of the parks, he really liked the green houses foliage plants. The work is very bizarre, and very much based in free association, the work is titled the dream is the dreamer dreaming is she dreaming etc.

Thomas Cole the oxbox 1836

Cole painted the Connecticut river, the work is just a normal landscape which he observed directly, Cole and his followers were part of the Hudson River school, who largely painted the Hudson river, basically in the north east. Painters wanted to make a unique authentic version of an American painting. Many felt America was unique and to be about America, but the style is a very conventional painting of America. Cole is in the work himself, and shows in turn what he has made is his own creation and nothing else. The work comes out of the 1830s and the manifest destiny period of US History. The idea is that the land itself was blessed and provided as a God given right. We are left with the question what is Cole saying in the work. We don't know if the storm is rolling in or out. In our modern era we believe Cole may be critiquing what's going on, may have been critiquing the American Empire, The work can be seen as a political statement against destroying land, should we urbanize or allow our society to be rural.

Wang Jian white Clouds Over Xiao and Xiang 1668

Europeans were late to landscaping, and it became a little more popular during the 17th-18th century, but only during the 19th century did it really become a thing. For thousands of years in the east, the Chinese made landscapes, and revered the tendency to copy extensively in art. In China copying art was essential to art making and art making practice. The text basically just has the lineage of artists going on. The work isn't a specific site, it's a place for the viewer to wander in their minds within it for our imagination.

Robert Smithson Spiral Jetty Great salt Lake Utah 1970

Did something that seems radical, Stonehenge, working on pyramids, or moving the earth to make something, a space a landscape sculpture etc, Robert Smithson is doing this. The artists knew it was going to change, in a very out of the way place that needs to be seen with a pilgrimage level journey. Smithson had many drawings, and made a film about the creation of the work. Smithson creates the spiral shape to relate the work to entropy and to nature. Smithson's work coincides with Earth Day a key day for the ecology movement. Smithson was at the forefront of earth art. Many do work in this vein, and nature is their theme and medium here.

Andy Goldsworthy Japanese Maple Leaves

Nature is the theme subject and meaning of the work. The work is very ephemeral and lasted only a day from Nov 21st-22, and the original work is gone it is a very temporary work.

Goldsworthy has made more permanent works before like a giant rockwall in ct he commed to do. We can call Goldsworthy works as nature sculptures He gets commed at 4atomerk

Art About Art and its Institutions

Most modern or contemporary art generally tends to have some sublevel where the work is concerned about art itself, its traditions etc and asserting their own voice into the mix.

Diego Velazquez Las Meninas 1656 The Maids of Honor

A masterwork with lifesize figures, made under the Baroque period, an important period for establishing borders as they remain in the modern day. The HRE really begins to dissolve, and art within each country takes on their own identity, and Velazquez becomes a master of Spanish baroque art. This work is considered to be a genius work since it is about more than one thing, the work is about art making itself and the role of the artist in the process of art and the role of the paint rin the royal family.

Velazquez is pictured in the work as the painter, and has a little red cross on himself, since he was knighted later on, and was marked as a knight of santiago. Velzquez was knighted for being a skilled painter not for his brith etc. You would get your own studio etc within the palace steady work, and we look into the workshop. In the center is the princess surrounded by her mades. The gy in the door wy is some butler figure Within the work there appears to be either a mirror or a painting. The work is about teh role of the artist within the palace life.

Yasumasa Morimura In Praise of Velazquez Distinguishes ones in Confinement 2013

Chromogenic Print

Morimura appropriated Velazquez's work and photographed his face into the face of every person in the work, this is his take on being a photographe himself. The original maids of honor is seen in the background of the work. So many other artists wanted to make their own variant of the work.

Pablo Picasso Las Meninas 1957

Picasso transforms Velazquez studio into his own, and doe sa cubist sork.

Joel Peter Witkin Las Meninas 1987

The work appears to be surrealist, hard to describe but at least similar.

Guerilla Girls 1985

A group which is formed in 1985, and does a rift on guerilla warfare in their name, lots of humour, an anonymous group of artists that highlights the inequity of female artists. Done with propaganda, little works put around the city. Would have confeerences in gorilla masks eating bananas. In 1985 there was a single femal display at the museum of modern art. Still active to this day, but in their hayday they were more popular.

Chapter 14 Ancient Mediterranean Wolds

Greece in the ancient World

Greece achieved its high point culturally in 440 BCE, Greece considered of differing polities all competing culturally artistically etc. Greece's terrain was very harsh and did not allow for the various peoples to unify. One common thing among these people was Greek humanism, which is why the Greeks are considered to be the beginning of western civilization since man is the measure of all things, and the idea that man is superior to all beings on his planet, and this idea originates with the Greeks. The Greeks were polytheistic, the Greeks believed that there Gods were immortal but took human form. When people made beautiful Greek sculptures, they really believed that the God or Goddess could inhabit that sculpture. The only difference between us and the Gods is that the Gods were immortal. Democracy originated here but also believed in slavery being natural and that women should be home bound.

The Greeks referred to themselves as the Hellenes. Greek city states were polis singular polis. During the fifth century Plato Aristotle etc came to the fore. The first Olympic games were held in 776 BCE.

Krater 750 BCE Geometric Work

The first period in Greek art history is known as the Geometric period, most pottery survived and ceramics. This work is 4-5 feet, and is called the geometric style because the work, and all the people themselves take on a similar reshape. It is believed that this was a funerary vessel. People are not very realistic. This work generally would've been a grave marker, and drain these vessels out and nourish a deceased person. Rain water would drain down too.

Kouros 600 BCE and Menakure and His Queen

Kouros means youth, Kouros is the female variant, and the work is 6 and a half feet tall from the archaic phase, an earlier phase in Greek art. Both works have the left foot forward and clenched fists, very symmetrical, upright, both start with a block of stone and retain that. The Archaic phase began a stark change from Egyptian art. The Egyptian work was diorite, and the Greek work was marble. Kouros was a nude. By the archaic phase the Greeks already tried free standing, since the legs and arms break away from the original block of stone.

Warrior A c 450 BCE

Bronze Statue

Bronze statue original from the era Found off the coast of Italy known as the Riace Warriors, found in 1972. Not Roman copies. The moment where the classical style becomes codified. Lasts for 2000 years. The work is in contrapposto, has opened eyes The Greeks understand that the spine is flexible, and that when we bend a knee that the rest of our body our head our arms needs to change as well. Very often Greeks did art of their sports players like disc throwers. Kouros is made very realistic many anatomically correct details,

Characteristics of Classical Art

1. Contrapposto, depicts movement
2. Detail, level of detail is much higher
3. Idealization, like no wrinkles no warts, everyone is young and beautiful

4. 7:1 ratio is used in classical period, head is the unit of measure, contrast to ourous doesn't look realistic enough
5. Modeling, rounded weighty volumetric, is the form believably three dimensional, the warrior is well modeled, the figure on the right is very organic
- 6.

Subject matter typically gods goddesses or athletes were the subject matter. Both were freestanding works, broken away from the rock.